

1951–54

JANUARY–JUNE 1951

The Viet Minh launch an offensive against French defenses in the Red River Delta, which is defeated with heavy losses.

OCTOBER–NOV 1952

France carries out an in-depth assault on Viet Minh-held areas of northern Vietnam in Operation Lorraine.

OCTOBER 1953

Cambodia and Laos are declared fully independent of French rule.



Laos becomes independent, 1953